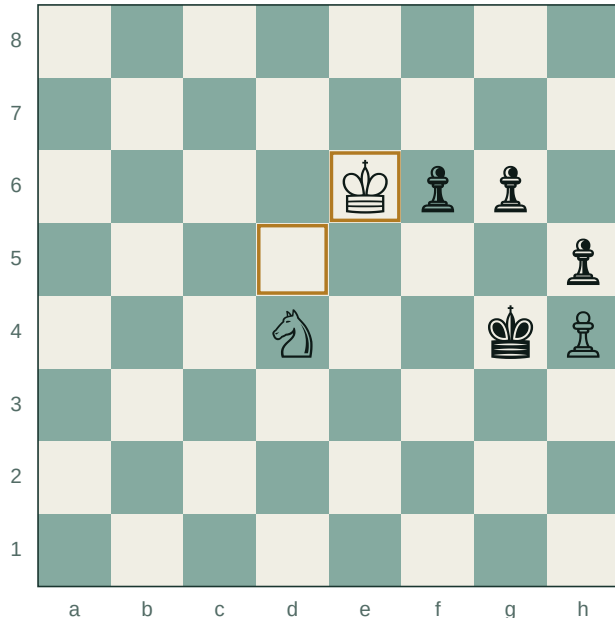


Knight-ending routes: Black, move 62

Knight-ending routes

Black to move



Previous move: 62.Ke6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

62...g5 63. hxg5 fxg5 64. Kd5 h4 65. Ke4 h3 66. Nf3 Kg3

62...g5 The pawn moves from g6 to g5. Recorded reply: **63.hxg5**.

63...fxg5 The pawn captures the pawn on g5. Recorded reply: **64.Kd5**.

64...h4 The pawn moves from h5 to h4. Recorded reply: **65.Ke4**.

65...h3 The pawn moves from h4 to h3. Recorded reply: **66.Nf3**.

66...Kg3 The king moves from g4 to g3.

At the end, nominal material is White 3 / Black 2 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +0. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +0: the balance goes from -1 to -1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A knight changes color with every move and may need a detour. Check the route square by square before trusting a race estimate.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Knight endings reward exact route calculation. Forks can change a pawn race, while a distant passer may outrun the knight's short-range movement.

HOW TO LOOK

Map the knight's checking moves and its route to the critical blockade square. Count moves rather than judging distance by appearance.

The defending king is on e6. Geometrically undefended: knight on d4. Check for tactical protection.